

Creating a Storage System using Rockstor

A storage system for data is one of the things that most computer users need. Solutions vary from the DIY kind to expensive cloud storage. This article points the reader to Rockstor, a DIY network attached storage (NAS) system.



Common complaints from prosumers and small business owners with respect to storage systems are: a server or hard disk tends to crash when it matters most; one often runs out of storage space at the wrong time; and the challenges in selecting the best storage solution from myriad options. Eventually, many users end up choosing an inappropriate storage solution for their needs.

This article guides you on how to select an appropriate storage solution. It also describes an easy way to build a complete storage system using inexpensive hardware and Rockstor, a CentOS based Linux distro.

By the end of this article:

1. Prosumers will learn how to build a storage system using Rockstor.
2. Small and medium business users will be able to determine whether a Linux based DIY NAS or a dedicated NAS server (Rockstor Pro B) is appropriate for their needs.

Hardware requirements for building a storage system

When it comes to building your Linux based storage system, there are three approaches you could take:

1. Assemble a NAS from components
2. Build on top of pre-built servers or old hardware, or even a hypervisor
3. Buy a pre-built Linux NAS box from a Linux NAS distro provider

Assembling a DIY NAS from components: This approach is recommended for prosumers who are tinkerers at heart and like to experiment, build and break stuff. The advantage of this approach is its low cost, a high degree of control and the thrill of building a NAS. The disadvantages of this approach are that it's time consuming and needs some degree of technical expertise.

If you decide to take this approach, the following are